Summer 2013

The Mountainside

Coolfont Mountainside Association

Volume XII Issue 1

THOUGHTS FROM THE PRESIDENT By Arnold Weinberg

Come out, come out, wherever you are! I'm sure everyone, at some time, has played Hide & Seek. Each year there is a Hide & Seek game at Coolfont. While the Board and Committee Chairpersons SEEK volunteers, over 200 CMA members HIDE. We usually find the same 20-25 homeowners as they do not try to hide. Some CMA members feel that their total responsibility to Coolfont is to pay their yearly assessment and fees. While payment of financial obligations is critical, it is very difficult for a community like Coolfont to operate without volunteer participation.



This year there are four Board seats up for election. Our Nomination Chairman, Rusty McCrady and I were challenged to find enough candidates to fill the slate. It is rare for CMA to have a true election in which there are more candidates than open Board seats. With the difficulty in securing candidates for Board positions, we need to examine the wisdom of limiting Board membership to three consecutive terms. The current Term Limit Policy states, that after serving three consecutive terms, a Board member cannot be nominated for a fourth consecutive term. The Board will be looking into this policy.

Each year it costs CMA over $300 to mail election material to CMA members. In an election where the number of candidates is equal to the number of open Board positions, the Board will look into electing these candidates by acclamation. This can be done by CMA group e-mail, saving us $300.

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LIVING WITH SNAKES By Craig Deane & Cathy Levey

The local black bears, with all their antics and charm, have grabbed the attention of our community over the past couple of years. As entertaining and infuriating as the bears have been, we suspect some of our other wildlife neighbors are equally deserving of our attentions. For this reason, we would like to focus on another of our neighbors, the many varied snakes, both venomous and nonvenomous, who inhabit our mountainside community. Some general facts about snakes as well as safety tips for living safely among snakes follows.

It is normal to see snakes in this area and snakes are a crucial part of the environment on the mountainside, helping to keep the rodent

(con't on page 2)

Calendar of Events

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July 4 Holiday

Pool Party and Barbeque will be held at 4:30 p.m. on

Saturday July 6

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July 20

Board Meeting, CMA Office, 10 a.m.

Potluck Dinner-6:30 p.m.

Need a volunteer

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August 10

Board Meeting, CMA Office, 10 a.m.

Potluck Dinner-6:30 p.m.

Denny & Evelyn Brydges-Q-4

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Saturday August 31

Pool Party & Annual Pig Roast 4:30 p.m.

September 21

Board Meeting, CMA Office, 10 a.m.

Potluck Dinner-6:30 a.m.

Arnold & Marlene Weinberg

October 26

CMA Annual Meeting

LIVING WITH SNAKES

(CON'T from p1)

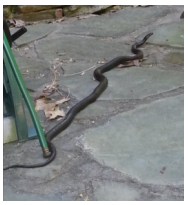
population under control. There are currently 22 species of snakes in West Virginia, falling under two categories or families: the colubridae family and the viperidae family. Only two of our species are poisonous and they both fall under the viperidae family. That would be the Northern Copperhead and the Timber Rattlesnake. The remaining nonvenomous snakes fall under the colubridaw family and include the Queen Snake, the Common Water Snake, the Northern Brown Snake, the Northern Red-bellied Snake, the Common Ribbon Snake, the Eastern Garter Snake, the Eastern Smooth Earth Snake, the Mountain Earth Snake, the Eastern Hog-nosed Snake, Northern Ring-necked Snake, the Eastern Worm Snake, the Northern Black Racer, the Rough Green Snake, the Smooth Green Snake, the Corn Snake, the Black Rat Snake, the Northern Pine Snake, the Eastern King Snake, the Black King Snake, and the Eastern Milk Snake (whew!) Most snakes lay eggs in the soil or leaves or sawdust piles, but some snakes, such as rattlesnakes and copperheads, have what appear to be live births. In both cases, the young are born as miniature adults and are fully self-sufficient.

All snakes are carnivores, feeding on small insects, earthworms, fish, rodents, frogs, lizards, birds and other snakes. Most snakes spend much of their lives hidden under rocks and logs while some snakes also live near the water and in branches of trees. Although some snakes can become quite large, using constriction as a means of subduing their prey, most snakes remain small.

Some snakes in West Virginia are very common, such as the Garter Snake and Black Rat Snake which can be found everywhere, while others, such as the Corn Snake and Northern Pine Snake, have been seen only a few times over the past several years. The Timber Rattlesnake is a species that is on the decline as a result of loss of natural habitat and senseless killing.

Living among our neighbors, the snakes, can be a satisfying and rewarding experience if certain common sense rules of behavior are followed. First and foremost, there is no such thing as an attack snake and snakes will only attack when threatened. Even the venomous snakes are not particularly aggressive and most snake bites occur when people attempt to handle them. The WV Department of Natural Resources has a one page information sheet on line which describes the identifying characteristics of venomous and nonvenomous snakes. (WV DNR Wildlife Diversity Program Information Sheet: Identifying Venomous and Nonvenomous Snakes.) Two very obvious differences are the broad, arrow-shaped heads of the venomous snakes versus the slender, narrow heads of the nonvenomous snakes and the elliptical shape of the eye with a pit or opening of the venomous snake versus the round pupil of the nonvenomous snake with no pit or opening. These characteristics can be seen from several feet away, this being a safe distance for observing snakes, as snakes can only strike, at the most, a distance of half their body length.

Snake bites are very rare and usually occur when someone is not following basic precautions. When walking the trails or hiking, long pants and hiking boots are recommended. Don't put hands and feet where you can't see them. For example, never step over a log where you can't see the other side and don't walk through tall grasses or wet areas where snakes are likely to occur. Around homes, piles of debris and wood piles make good homes for mice, which attract the snakes. If you encounter a snake, the best approach is to leave it alone and it will most likely leave on its own accord.



Blacksnake

For more information on snakes, the WV DNR offers some helpful and enlightening information on their web site www.wvdnr.gov. By staying informed and following basic precautions, our experience with our wildlife neighbors can not only be a non-threatening one; it can also elicit a sense of awe and wonder.

MEMORIAL DAY

By Lois Copeland

Our Memorial Day Pool Party and cookout was a huge success. Wonderful seeing old friends and new ones, seeing our grandchildren growing up, and seeing Martha Ashelman back for a visit. The food was delicious and plentiful as always. So what was missing—warm weather.? Yes, like other special times on the mountainside, the weather did not cooperate,. The pig roast last Labor Day and the annual meeting several years ago were two such occasions. But like true mountain people we weathered the storm once again.

Is that Dilys Parry huddled in a long coat and Larry Merola in a warm sweatshirt, Why yes!





Two other CMA mountaineers, Flo Merola and Joanie Zuckerman dressed for winter.

Welcome New Neighbors

By Marlene Weinberg

CMA is delighted to welcome as its newest members three families who have settled on homes since the last newsletter was distributed.

In November, 2012, Bob Ensinger and Peter Larson settled on E-2, on Whipporwill Way, previously owned by Meredith Myers. Bob and Peter and their six year old son, Heath, have their primary residence in Falls Church, VA. Both Bob and Peter are non-profit professionals and list tennis and travel among their interests. Their familiarity with Coolfont goes back to the mid-1990's when they rented a place here with friends. They always liked the community as well as Berkeley Springs. With no plans to rent their house, newly named "Chalet du Bois", Bob and Peter envision using it primarily as a weekend get-away.

November, 2012, also brought us Greg and Karyn Kendall who settled on S-2, on Wintergreen Way, previously owned by Sandy and Tom Hess. Two young sons, Evan and Ryan, and a yellow lab named Reilly complete the Kendall household. Greg and Karyn's primary residence is in Washington, D.C. where Greg works for an environmental consulting company and Karyn works for the Federal government. The Kendalls had been to the Berkeley Springs area several times before and enjoyed the town as well as Cacapon State Park. They found information on Coolfont rentals on the internet and stayed in the community a couple of times enjoying its quiet seclusion and its proximity to the town and park and then decided to purchase a home here. Greg and Karyn envision using their house as a weekend get-away as well as a part-time rental. They think they will retain the existing name, "Kismet." As he becomes more familiar with the functions of CMA, Greg expressed an interest in helping with trail clearing and helping out with reservoir system maintenance.



Welcome to our new neighbors!!

The most recent newcomers are May arrivals Tim Flanagan and Mary Hodges who settled on I-2, on Mountainside Loop, previously owned by Joan Zaro and Carl Thomason. Rounding out their family are six-month old Eleanor Grace Flanagan and a beagle/ lab mix named Nellie. Tim and Mary live in the Brookland neighborhood of Northeast, D.C. Tim is the Executive Director of the Washington Area Community Investment Fund (WACIF), a community development loan fund serving mostly low - to- moderate communities in the Capitol Region. He is also working towards a Masters in Accountancy from the George Washington University. Mary is the Director of Marketing for the Menkiti Group, a local real estate and development company focused on workforce housing and first -time homebuyers. Mary and Tim have an extensive list of interests including cooking and traveling as a family. Tim loves grilling, Philadelphia sports teams, chess, playing guitar, golf, and skiing and country/bluegrass music. Mary loves baking, art museums, volunteering, nature walks, swimming and yoga. Tim and Mary were drawn to Coolfont by its "welcoming feel, community amenities, unique and diverse housing stock and overall feeling that it was peaceful, wooded and serene." The pool was a big plus, as were the playground, playing field, and hiking trails. While they will continue to keep their house listed for rental, their hope is to use it as much as possible. Tim and Mary believe "Idyllife" is a fitting name for their house and plan to retain it. They hope to be able to support the operation of CMA, bringing with them their experience in real estate and finance.

In addition to the transactions listed above, E-5 on Whipporwill Way was recently sold to a builder/contractor who intends to renovate the house and put it back on the market; so, we anticipate another homeowner to welcome in the near future.

Presidential Thoughts

(con't from p1)

U.S. Mail can be used for those without e-mail.

There are ways to save additional money, as well, in elections where there are more candidates than open Board positions. A bonded service will send out ballots to eligible voters by e-mail, tabulate the votes and issue the results. This will cost us less than $100. The Board will look into this as well. Again, U.S. Mail can be used for those without e-mail.

In closing, remember that local bears are in their breeding season. Mama bears will chase off their yearlings so they may breed again. Yearlings are on their own for the first time and will be looking for easy food sources. **PLEASE SECURE YOUR TRASH.**



Coolfont Mountainside Association

CMA
P.O. Box 418
Berkeley Springs, WV 25411
Arnold Weinberg, President
(H)410-730-4681 (CMA)304-258-9199
marzarn@comcast.com
Lois Copeland, Editor
301-530-1115, 304-258-8127
loiscopeland52@gmail.com
Website:
www.coolfontmountainside.org
Listserv address:
cma-members@googlegroups.com

CONGRATULATIONS

- To Hallie Kerr, a grandson, **Bruno Jack Malone**, born September 6, 2012. Proud parents, Hal Dennis (Denny) Malone and Susan Denise Hayman.
- To Dennis and Evelyn Brydges, a grandson, **Aiden Chapman Brydges.** Proud parents Todd Brydges and Alethia Baggett.
- To Cathy Levey, her son, **Christopher Louis Brune**, graduated from Hood College, Frederick, Maryland with a bachelors degree in Psychology, May 18.
- To **Larry and Flo Merola**, move to a new home in Leisure World.
- To **Bob and Jean Cohen** on their 50th Wedding Anniversary August 25.







THINKING ABOUT TAMARI

By Marlene Weinberg

For those of you who attended the dinner following the 2011 Annual Meeting, you may recall the following song being sung to honor Mary Ellen and Elias Tamari who were planning a move:

(To the tune of "Tomorrow" from Annie)

We're thinking about Tamaris.
Bet your bottom dollar the
Tamaris will be missed.
If things work out they'll leave us.
But they'll be nearby and we will visit.
That's our plan.
Tamaris, Tamaris, we'll miss the Tamaris.
We're always your Coolfont friends.

After a few delays, the Tamaris made the move this past March to the Friends House in Sandy Spring, MD, a retirement community under Quaker auspices. Their new location puts them within a 20 minute drive of their daughter Marisa, her husband David and their triplets. While missing their Coolfont and Berkeley Springs friends, Mary Ellen and Elias are enjoying the conveniences of their new home and the amenities it offers. And, they both agree, "the food is wonderful and the Washington Post is delivered every morning!"

The Tamaris bought their Coolfont house in 1991 and, after decades of international travel, including living in Haiti, Algeria, Bangladesh and the Ivory Coast of Africa, moved there permanently in 2001. While their new quarters at the Friends House required that they scale down their furnishings, they have retained enough of the fascinating memorabilia they have collected over their many years abroad to give their new home the same exotic aura that many enjoyed at their Coolfont home. They are intending to rent their Coolfont house for now and, for those who think they may have seen Mary Ellen zipping through town in the little red VW Beetle, they did sell it locally!

Mary Ellen and Elias send their regards to their Coolfont friends and would welcome visits, calls, notes and e-mails. Their contact information is as follows;

Mary Ellen and Elias Tamari
Friends House
17320 Quaker Lane,
Apt B-6
Sandy Spring, MD
20860

301-804-4145
ellentamari@aol.com

As the song says, we are thinking about Tamaris and they are most definitely missed!